RideCrest Transport Policies

Oct 13, 2026 · @Hamad Syed Haidari

RideCrest's six written policies for passenger transport contracts with Southampton City Council and Hampshire County Council.

About these policies

These policies cover every journey RideCrest runs under a council transport contract, and everyone who works on one.

Item	Details
Company	RideCrest Taxis Limited, trading as RideCrest
Company number	17420363 (England and Wales)
Registered office	183 Golden Grove, Southampton, SO14 1TD
Operator licence	Private hire operator licence OP 428, Southampton City Council
Data protection	Registered with the Information Commissioner's Office, ZC259598
Policy owner	Hamad Syed Haidari, Director
Contact	07541 109738, ridecresttaxis@gmail.com
Approved	13 October 2026
Next review	October 2027, or sooner if the law, a contract or the way RideCrest works changes

RideCrest's drivers are self-employed. Each holds a Southampton City Council private hire driver's licence and drives a car licensed by the same council, usually their own. The policies also cover any passenger assistant RideCrest provides.

Every driver gets a copy of these policies, and of the council's driver code of conduct for the contract, before their first contract journey. They confirm in writing that they have read them, and RideCrest keeps that confirmation with their driver record.

Vehicle maintenance policy

Every car on a RideCrest contract is safe, roadworthy, clean and licensed by Southampton City Council whenever it carries passengers. Drivers maintain their own cars, and RideCrest checks that they do.

Daily checks

Before the first journey of each day, the driver checks:

- tyres: pressure, damage and tread depth (at least the legal 1.6 mm)
- lights, indicators, brakes, steering and horn
- windscreen, wipers, washers and mirrors
- oil, coolant and brake fluid, and any dashboard warning lights
- seat belts in every seat, doors, locks and child locks
- heating and ventilation, and a clean inside
- the council camera working, and licence plates and door stickers in place
- the first aid kit, warning triangle, and any child or booster seats the contract needs

The driver records each check on a daily check sheet and keeps the sheets for 12 months. A car that fails a check does not go out until it is fixed, and the driver tells RideCrest straight away so another car can cover the route.

Servicing, tests and documents

- Each car is serviced at the maker's intervals, and the driver keeps the receipts.
- Each car passes the council's inspection when its licence is renewed and an MOT test six months later once it is over 2 years old, as Southampton's licence conditions require.
- Cars are kept to their original specification, as the licence requires.
- RideCrest records every car's licence, MOT and insurance expiry dates on its driver and car records, and reminds the driver 4 weeks before each is due. A car with any document out of date does no RideCrest work.

Defects

- Drivers report any defect to RideCrest the same day, by phone or WhatsApp.
- A fault that affects safety, such as brakes, steering, tyres, lights, seat belts or doors, keeps the car off the road until it is repaired.
- RideCrest logs each defect, the repair and the date it was fixed.

- Accident damage is reported to Southampton City Council licensing within 3 days and repaired within a month, as the licence requires. The car may need re-inspecting before it works again.

Spot checks

RideCrest spot-checks every car used on contracts at least once every 3 months, without notice. The check covers the daily checklist above and the car's licence, plates, insurance and MOT. Results go on the car's record, and any failure is fixed before the car's next contract journey.

Garages

Each driver uses a garage of their choice and gives RideCrest its name and phone number for their record. For any car RideCrest provides, servicing and repairs are done by a garage RideCrest chooses, and its name and phone number are kept on that car's record.

Signed: Hamad Syed Haidari, Director, 13 October 2026

Safeguarding policy

Every child and adult at risk who travels with RideCrest must be kept safe from abuse, neglect, harm and exploitation, and everyone who drives for RideCrest shares that duty. RideCrest's Designated Safeguarding Lead is Hamad Syed Haidari, Director, on 07541 109738 or ridecresttaxis@gmail.com.

Checks before anyone works on a contract

- A Southampton City Council private hire driver's licence, which requires an enhanced DBS check including both the children's and adults' barred lists, a subscription to the DBS Update Service, and council-approved safeguarding training.
- RideCrest checks each driver's DBS status on the Update Service, with their consent, before their first contract journey and every 6 months after that.
- Any approval the council needs, such as Hampshire County Council's driver authorisation, before the driver's first journey on that council's contract. No stand-in driver works a route without the council's approval.
- Drivers must tell RideCrest straight away if they are arrested, charged, convicted or investigated by the police, as well as telling the council as their licence requires.

Training

Drivers keep their safeguarding training in date, renewing it at least every 3 years, and complete any training a council asks for. RideCrest goes through this policy and the council's code of conduct with every driver before their first contract journey and again each year.

How drivers behave

- Wear their ID badge and treat passengers, parents, carers and school staff politely and professionally.
- Never use language or make remarks that are personal, sexual, racist or offensive.
- Only touch a passenger when needed for their safety, such as fastening a seat belt a child can't manage, and say what they're doing first.
- Never give a passenger their personal number or social media, contact a passenger outside work, or give gifts.
- Never photograph or film a passenger, apart from the camera the council requires in the car.
- Carry no one else on a contract journey, make no stops that aren't on the route, and never let a child out anywhere except their school or home.
- Keep passengers' details and route information private, and destroy them when no longer needed.
- Never smoke or vape, or drive after alcohol or drugs that could affect their driving.

Safe pick-up and drop-off

- Stop on the same side of the road as the pick-up or drop-off point wherever possible.
- Check every passenger's seat belt, and any child seat, before moving off, and check the car is empty at the end of the journey.
- Wait for the time the contract sets, then report a passenger who doesn't appear before leaving.
- Hand a child over only to the school or to the adult named for the journey. If no one is there to receive a child, the driver keeps them safely in the car and calls RideCrest, which contacts the council for instructions. The child is never left alone.

Spotting and reporting a concern

Signs of harm include unexplained injuries, sudden changes in behaviour, a child seeming frightened to go home, or a child saying something worrying. If a child tells a driver something, the driver listens calmly, doesn't promise to keep it secret, doesn't ask leading

questions, and writes down what was said in the child's own words, with the date and time.

1. If anyone is in immediate danger, call 999.
2. Otherwise tell the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day, before the end of the shift.
3. The Lead reports it the same day to the council that arranged the journey, and to children's or adult social care where needed.
4. If the Lead can't be reached, the driver reports straight to the council and social care using the contacts below.

Allegations against a driver or assistant

The Lead refers any allegation that a driver or assistant has harmed a child, or may be unsuitable to work with children, to the Local Authority Designated Officer (LADO) within one working day, and tells the council that arranged the journey and Southampton City Council licensing. The driver comes off contract work while it is looked into, which is not a finding of guilt. RideCrest follows the LADO's and police's advice, and doesn't investigate on its own.

Contacts

Who	When	Contact
Police	Anyone in immediate danger	999
RideCrest Designated Safeguarding Lead	Every concern, the same day	Hamad Syed Haidari, 07541 109738, ridecresttaxis@gmail.com
Southampton School Travel Service	A concern on a Southampton contract	023 8083 2419
Hampshire County Council School Transport	A concern on a Hampshire contract	The emergency contacts in the contract
Southampton Children's Resource Service	A child in Southampton	023 8083 2300 (Monday to Thursday 8.30am to 5pm, Friday to 4.30pm), out of hours 023 8023 3344
Hampshire Children's Services	A child in Hampshire	01329 225 379 (professionals, same hours), out of hours 0300 555 1373
Southampton Adult Social Care	An adult at risk in Southampton	023 8083 3003

Who	When	Contact
Hampshire Adult Social Care	An adult at risk in Hampshire	Online safeguarding referral on hants.gov.uk
Southampton LADO	An allegation on a Southampton contract	023 8091 5535, LADO@southampton.gov.uk
Hampshire LADO	An allegation on a Hampshire contract	Notification form to LADO@hants.gov.uk
Police non-emergency	A crime that isn't an emergency	101

Records

RideCrest records every concern: who raised it, what was said or seen, when, and what was done. Records are kept securely and shared only with those who need to know, such as the council, social care, the LADO or the police.

Signed: Hamad Syed Haidari, Director, 13 October 2026

Health and safety policy

RideCrest protects passengers, drivers and the public from injury and loss on every journey. The Director, Hamad Syed Haidari, is responsible for health and safety and is RideCrest's health and safety contact, on 07541 109738 or ridecresttaxis@gmail.com.

Who does what

- **The Director** writes the risk assessments, makes sure every driver is licensed, approved and briefed, looks into every incident, and reviews this policy each year.
- **Drivers** are self-employed and responsible for their own car and safe driving. They follow this policy and the council's code of conduct, and report hazards and incidents straight away.
- **Passenger assistants**, where RideCrest provides them, follow the council's code of conduct for assistants and its training.

Risk assessments

Before each contract starts, RideCrest assesses its risks in writing: the route, every pick-up and drop-off point, and each passenger's needs as the council describes them, such as child seats, medical needs or behaviour support. The driver gets a copy before the first

journey. The assessment is reviewed whenever anything changes, and at least once a year. These are the main risks and how RideCrest controls them:

Risk	How RideCrest controls it
Tired drivers	No more than 10 hours' driving a day, a 30-minute break after 5½ hours, and no driving when unwell or tired
Distraction	No phone use while driving, satnav set before moving off, hands-free calls only when parked
Getting in and out	Stop somewhere safe on the same side as the pick-up point, with child locks on and passengers using the kerb-side doors
Seat belts and child seats	Every belt checked before moving off, and child or booster seats fitted where the contract needs them
Car faults	Daily checks and spot checks, as the vehicle maintenance policy sets out
Bad weather	Check forecasts, leave earlier, drive to the conditions, and follow the business continuity policy
Lifting and handling	Drivers only lift bags they can manage safely, and only trained drivers secure wheelchairs
Aggression or violence	Stay calm, stop somewhere safe, call 999 if threatened, and report it
Working alone	A charged phone at all times, and RideCrest knows each driver's route and times
Medical emergencies	A first aid kit in every car, 999 called straight away, and any care plan the council gives followed

Safe driving

Drivers follow the Highway Code, keep to speed limits, never smoke or vape in the car, and never drive after alcohol or drugs that could affect their driving. They stay medically fit to drive and tell the DVLA and Southampton City Council licensing about any condition that could affect it.

Reporting incidents

1. In an emergency, call 999.
2. The driver tells RideCrest as soon as it is safe, and RideCrest tells the council that arranged the journey the same day.
3. The driver records the date, time, place, who was involved, what happened, any injuries, any witnesses and what was done, within 24 hours.
4. After a road accident, the driver exchanges details, reports to the police where the law requires, and RideCrest tells Southampton City Council licensing within 3 days and the insurer.
5. Where the law requires, RideCrest reports the incident to the Health and Safety Executive under RIDDOR.
6. RideCrest looks into what happened, changes the risk assessment if needed, and shares what was learned with every driver.

Keeping safety front of mind

RideCrest briefs every driver on this policy before their first contract journey and each year, and sends safety reminders by WhatsApp when something changes, such as bad weather or roadworks on a route. Drivers can raise a safety concern at any time, and RideCrest acts on it.

Signed: Hamad Syed Haidari, Director and person responsible for health and safety, 13 October 2026

Customer complaints policy

RideCrest acknowledges every complaint within 2 working days and gives its findings within 14 days. Complaints on a council contract are reported to that council within 1 working day. These are the same steps RideCrest's booking terms give its private customers.

Making a complaint

Anyone can complain: a passenger, parent, carer, school or the council. They can call or WhatsApp 07541 109738, email ridecresttaxis@gmail.com, or write to RideCrest at its registered office. A complaint made by phone is written down and read back to the person to check it is right. A complaint about a child's or adult's safety is handled under the safeguarding policy straight away.

Timescales

Step	When
Tell the council, for a complaint on a council contract	Within 1 working day
Acknowledge the complaint	Within 2 working days
Report a complaint about a driver's behaviour or safety to Southampton City Council licensing	Within 3 working days
Give the findings and what RideCrest will do	Within 14 days

Gathering the evidence

RideCrest gets the driver's account in writing and the account of the person complaining. It checks the booking and route records, journey times and messages, and speaks to any witnesses, such as a passenger assistant or school staff. Where footage from the council-approved camera in the car may help, RideCrest asks Southampton City Council licensing, which controls access to it. The evidence is kept together with the complaint record.

Reaching and sharing the outcome

The Director decides the outcome from the evidence and writes to the person who complained, explaining what was found and what RideCrest will do. For a complaint on a council contract, the council gets the same reply and RideCrest follows any steps the council requires. If the person is still unhappy, the Director looks at it again, and they can also contact the council or Southampton City Council licensing, which licenses RideCrest, its drivers and their cars.

Records and reporting

Every complaint and compliment is logged in RideCrest's complaints record, with the date, the person, the journey, what happened, the evidence, the outcome and the action taken. RideCrest sends each council a summary of complaints and compliments on its contracts whenever the council asks, and passes compliments on to the driver.

Learning from complaints

The Director reviews the complaints record every month for patterns, such as the same route, driver or problem coming up more than once. What is learned goes into driver briefings and training and into the risk assessments, so the same problem doesn't happen again.

Signed: Hamad Syed Haidari, Director, 13 October 2026

Breakdowns and emergencies policy

In a breakdown or emergency, the driver keeps the passengers safe first. RideCrest then gets them to their destination in another licensed car, and keeps the council, the school and parents informed.

Keeping passengers safe

- **On an ordinary road**, the driver stops somewhere safe with hazard lights on. Passengers stay in the car with seat belts on, unless the car is at risk of fire or of being hit. The warning triangle goes at least 45 metres behind the car.
- **On a motorway or fast road**, the driver leaves at the next exit or services if the car can still move. If stopped on the hard shoulder or verge, everyone gets out by the doors away from the traffic and waits behind the safety barrier, well away from the car. No warning triangle is used on a motorway.
- **Stopped in a live lane** with no safe way out, everyone stays in the car with seat belts on and hazard lights on, and the driver calls 999 straight away.
- **If there is smoke or fire**, the driver switches off the engine, gets everyone out and well away from the car at once, calls 999, and nobody goes back for belongings.
- **Children** are kept together, counted, held by the hand if young, and kept away from traffic. They are never left alone or with anyone who isn't approved for the contract, including recovery staff. Where a passenger assistant is on board, they look after the children while the driver makes calls.
- **A passenger in a wheelchair** is only moved by a trained driver or assistant, when it is safe. Otherwise someone stays with them and the driver calls 999.

Who is told

1. The driver calls 999 if anyone is hurt or in danger, or the car is somewhere dangerous.
2. The driver calls RideCrest straight away on 07541 109738.
3. RideCrest tells the council that arranged the journey, such as Southampton's School Travel Service on 023 8083 2419 or Hampshire's emergency contact for the contract, and the school.
4. RideCrest tells parents or carers about the delay, as the contract sets out, if the journey will be more than 10 minutes late.
5. The driver keeps passengers calm and tells them what is happening.

Getting passengers there

RideCrest sends the nearest available licensed car with a driver approved for that council's contracts, aiming to arrive within 30 minutes, with any child seats or equipment the passengers need. The first driver stays with the passengers until they are handed over. If no RideCrest car can get there in good time, RideCrest asks the council how it wants the passengers moved. Every driver keeps breakdown cover with a national recovery service.

Recording and reporting

Within 24 hours, the driver records the date, time and place, what happened, who was on board, who was told and when, and when the replacement car arrived. RideCrest emails the council a written report the same day, reports any accident to Southampton City Council licensing within 3 days, and follows the incident steps in the health and safety policy. The Director then checks what caused it, such as a fault missed in the daily checks, and acts so it doesn't happen again.

Signed: Hamad Syed Haidari, Director, 13 October 2026

Business continuity policy

RideCrest keeps every contracted journey running when something goes wrong, and when a journey can't run safely, it tells the council and the school as early as possible. This table sets out what RideCrest does for each risk:

Risk	What RideCrest does
Snow, ice, flooding or storms	Checks Met Office warnings the evening before and early on the day, agrees with the council whether each route can run safely, and tells the council and school straight away about any delay. Drivers never drive through flood water, and safety always comes before keeping time.
A car breaks down or needs repair	Another licensed RideCrest car covers the route, as the breakdowns and emergencies policy sets out. Servicing is booked outside school-run times.
A driver or car licence is suspended	The driver or car comes off contract work at once, and an approved stand-in covers the route.

Risk	What RideCrest does
A driver is ill or on holiday	Each route has at least one other driver, approved by the council and briefed on the route, ready to cover. Holidays are agreed at least 2 weeks ahead, and the council approves any stand-in before they drive.
The Director is unavailable	A deputy the Director names in advance runs the day's work, with access to the route sheets and contacts.
A phone line fails	Calls are diverted to a backup mobile number, which drivers and councils also have. A spare charged phone is kept ready.
Internet or computer failure	RideCrest's records are kept online and can be reached from any phone or computer, and mobile data covers a broadband failure. Each driver has a printed sheet for their own route, kept out of sight and destroyed when the route changes.
RideCrest's office can't be used	The work is run from mobile phones anywhere, as nothing depends on the office.

Cars RideCrest provides or hires to drivers

- The car is licensed by Southampton City Council and insured for hire and reward before it carries passengers.
- RideCrest services it at the maker's intervals and safety-checks it every 4 weeks, on top of the driver's daily checks.
- RideCrest records its licence, MOT, insurance and service dates, and acts at least 4 weeks before each is due.
- The driver reports any fault, damage or warning light the same day, and RideCrest tells the driver about recalls, service bookings and anything that limits how the car can be used. Both sign a written hire agreement setting this out.

Keeping the plan up to date

RideCrest checks its contact lists and route cover at the start of every school term, and reviews this policy each year and after any disruption.

Signed: Hamad Syed Haidari, Director, 13 October 2026